



REDMOND TECH
ORCHESTRA PRESENTS

All the World's a Song

ORCHESTRAL THEMES INSPIRED BY SHAKESPEARE
FEATURING TECHNICALLY THESPIANS

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Program Notes

Felix Mendelssohn	A Midsummer Night's Dream, Op. 61	10'
	I. Scherzo	
	II. Fairies' March	
	IX. Wedding March	
William Walton	Henry V Suite	16'
	— Intermission —	
Sergei Prokofiev	Romeo and Juliet, Suite No. 2, Op. 64ter	35'

A Midsummer Night's Dream by Felix Mendelssohn

Felix Mendelssohn composed his music for *Shakespeare's A Midsummer Night's Dream* in two widely separate bursts of inspiration. Mendelssohn grew up steeped in Shakespeare, acting out his favorite scenes at home with his siblings, and the play's fairies, elves, and mischievous spirits were lifelong companions. In 1826, when he was only seventeen, he wrote the sparkling concert Overture, a feat of imagination few teenage composers have ever matched. Sixteen years later, on commission from the King of Prussia, Mendelssohn returned to the play and wrote a full set of incidental music (1842).

Tonight's selections are presented in the order they appear in the play. In the tale, four young Athenians flee into the forest, where the mischievous sprite Puck causes both young men to fall in love with the same maiden. While the four wanderers pursue one another through the woods, Puck helps his master execute a prank on the fairy queen. Eventually, Puck lifts the enchantment, leading the two couples to reconcile and marry.

I. Scherzo

The Scherzo is the play's first fairy interlude, spiriting us out of the daylight human world and into the moonlit realm of the forest. Listen for the featherlight opening in flutes, low clarinets, and bassoons, an instrumental color so novel it would later echo through Tchaikovsky, and for the darting, quicksilver figures that conjure Puck, "that merry wanderer of the night."

II. Fairies' March / L'istesso Tempo & Allegro vivace

This music heralds the arrival of Oberon and Titania, king and queen of the fairies, whose marital squabble sets the whole night's mischief in motion. Keep an ear out for the scampering strings and chattering woodwinds that send the fairies flitting through the moonlight, as the music quickens into the lively Allegro vivace. Oberon asks Puck for the enchanted flower filled with love-juice, intending to use it on Titania; he also instructs Puck to anoint Demetrius, who has rejected Helena despite her devoted love for him.

IX. Wedding March

Instantly recognizable, the Wedding March celebrates the triple wedding that ends the play. Pay attention to the trombones, making their only appearance in the score, as they return us to the human world of daylight and royal splendor. Long associated with Queen Victoria and generations of wedding ceremonies since, the march is heard tonight in its full form, including the expansive middle passages that are often skipped in more practical processional use.

Henry V Suite by William Walton

William Walton rose from working-class beginnings to become a pillar of English music. He was a largely self-taught modernist who scandalized conservative critics before winning them over with his Viola Concerto and First Symphony, to become a pillar of English music. During the Second World War, he wrote scores for patriotic films, the finest of them for Laurence Olivier's *Henry V* (1944). Olivier's film is a marvel of wartime artistry, and Walton's music is a large part of its magic, conjuring a convincing medieval "period" atmosphere out of a modern orchestra and weaving in Tudor tunes and French folk songs along the way. The concert suite arranges the music as a symmetrical arch: festive movements frame the whole, with two intimate pieces for strings alone at its heart.

The music provides the context for the play *Henry V* by William Shakespeare. Following an insult from the French Dauphin, England's King Henry V launches an invasion of France to assert his claim to the throne. Along the way, Henry thwarts a plot against his life, delivers inspiring speeches, and triumphs in battle despite overwhelming odds. Ultimately, he courts and weds the French Princess, uniting both realms.

I. Overture: The Globe Playhouse

The suite springs to life out of an expectant hush. Listen for the bright burst of trumpets and drums, and the vigorous, Tudor-tinged dance tunes that summon the rowdy Elizabethan crowd gathering at Shakespeare's Globe for the play.

II. Passacaglia: The Death of Falstaff

A brief, tender lament for strings alone, marking the passing of one of Shakespeare's most beloved characters, Falstaff. In the earlier historical plays, Falstaff embodies merry chaos, quick wit, and the convivial world of the tavern; by Henry V, his absence signals the King's passage out of youthful recklessness and into the burdens of heroic monarchy. Listen for the slow tread of the repeating bass line, over which the upper strings unfold a melody of quiet nobility, an entire farewell painted in just a few minutes.

III. Charge and Battle

In the film, this music does not accompany the sounds of war; it replaces them entirely. Listen for the driving rhythm of the English cavalry charging across the muddy field at Agincourt, until the first volley of arrows takes flight (prepare to duck!). After the fury subsides, an English horn enters with an exquisite solo musing on the French shepherd's song "Baïlero."

IV. Touch Her Soft Lips and Part

Again for strings alone, a lilting lullaby of a very different kind: a tender farewell as a soldier takes leave of his wife before sailing for France. Hear how the gently swaying melody, threaded throughout with the quiet sorrow of those who may never meet again.

V. Agincourt Song

The suite ends as it began, in festivity, now grander and more ceremonial. Listen for the brass intoning a stately modal hymn of victory over the excited bustle of strings and woodwinds, evoking the English army's triumphant homecoming from France.

Romeo and Juliet, Suite No. 2, Op. 64ter by Sergei Prokofiev

Sergei Prokofiev composed his ballet *Romeo and Juliet* in 1935, and from its richly dramatic score he later drew three orchestral suites. The second of them, heard tonight, follows the arc of Shakespeare's tragedy far more closely than the others. The ballet marked a turning point for Prokofiev, uniting the many sides of his musical personality: biting and modern, driving and motoric, satirical, and above all newly lyrical. It is his first great romantic stage work, and its portrait of the young lovers is among the most tender in all of ballet.

The seven movements tonight trace the story from the feuding streets of Verona to its heartbreaking end. A long-standing animosity between two powerful families repeatedly turns to bloodshed. Tensions rise when masked Montagues gatecrash a Capulet celebration, where Romeo Montague falls in love with Juliet Capulet, who is promised to Paris. They marry secretly the next day with her nurse's help. However, Romeo's attempt to stop a street brawl backfires, resulting in the death of Juliet's cousin Tybalt, and Romeo's banishment. To reunite, Juliet conspires with the friar and fakes her death. Tragically, the explanatory message fails to reach Romeo; believing her dead, he kills himself in her tomb. Juliet awakens to his corpse and takes her own life, prompting the grief-stricken families to finally end their bitter feud.

I. The Montagues and Capulets

Powerful and ominous as it is recognizable. Listen for the heavy, strutting “Dance of the Knights” from the Capulet ball, its lumbering menace suggesting noblemen who forgot to remove their armor, framed by the grim, threatening music of the Duke’s decree that the warring families cease their feud on pain of death.

II. The Young Juliet

A quicksilver portrait of Juliet as a teenager: teasing and impish one moment, then suddenly aware, perhaps for the first time, of the young woman she is becoming. Keep an ear for the breathless rush of the strings and the lyrical melody started first by the clarinet and soon after passed to the flute that hints at her blossoming maturity.

III. Friar Laurence

A solemn, kindly theme for the well-meaning priest whose scheme to reconcile the feuding families will, tragically, set the lovers on the path to their end. Pay attention to the bassoon and cello that give the friar his grave, benevolent presence.

IV. Dance

A vigorous, rustic dance from the opening of Act II that brings the streets of Verona to life with the energy of a town festival. Notice the snare drum and the strutting, jaunty tune in the oboe, a splash of color Prokofiev deploys with wonderful flair.

V. Romeo and Juliet Before Parting

The lovers’ final dawn together, an impassioned scene built on the great theme of Romeo’s love. In the orchestra, listen for that long-breathed melody soaring in the strings, shadowed from below by uneasy harmonies that hint at the misfortune to come.

VI. Dance of the Girls with Lilies

A delicate, melancholy dance performed on the morning of Juliet’s intended wedding to another man. Listen for the cool, glassy color of woodwinds and muted strings, whose graceful surface barely conceals the gathering tragedy beneath.

VII. Romeo at Juliet’s Grave

The devastating finale: Romeo, believing Juliet dead, takes his own life. Hear how the deep, descending lines in the lower strings and the anguished violin theme above them, gathering all the sorrow of the play into one final lament apparent in the massive brass segment before sinking into stillness. The massive brass segment before sinking into stillness.

Program notes by Sabrina Ang



Musician Roster

Violin I

Mirabai Smoot

Co-principal

Jerry He

Co-principal

Patrick Creighton

Assistant Principal

Angelina Chen

Audra Stump

Bryan Reich

Eveline Bogdanski

Isabel Milewski

Madeleine Jacobitz

Rachel Keirouz

William Sun

Violin II

Brandon Chen

Principal

Erica Choi

Assistant Principal

Aditya Ramanathan

Alan Zhu

Amrutha Srikanth

Amy Ouyang

Andrea Lum

Anirudh Kumar

Farrah Hasen

Frederick Huyan

Gabriel Mallari

Michael Manansala

Michelle Ding

Peter Chow

Rachael Tang

Rodrigo Castaño

Sahana Srivatsan

Sophie Zhao

Viola

Jacob Park

Principal

Eleanor Mengel

Assistant Principal

Anita Ambalavanan

Henry Wang

Jayden Yu

Josh Ye

Lauren Kam

Livia Kam

Sumit Choudhury

Cello

Dorian Latchague

Principal

Alaina Bossert

Assistant Principal

Lotus Kam Chow

Assistant Principal

Aleks Boljanac

Catherine Yang

Jason Dickens

Kevin Au

Nishita Manjunath

Taylor Thackaberry

Double Bass

Alex Hansen

Principal

Tanya Lai

Assistant Principal

Bonnie You

Supriya Dixit

Flute

Jennifer Lee

Alejandro Rios

Alex Ayala

Robin Goldstein

Hannah Bang

Nandhini

Lakuduva*

Martha Tran

Britania

Rodriguez Reyes

Piccolo

Alex Ayala*

Robin Goldstein*

Nandhini

Lakuduva*

Oboe

Jennifer Williams

Ivan Romero Wells*

English Horn

Ivan Romero Wells*

Clarinet

David Chen

Emily You

Helen Xiong

Michael Taylor

Renee Hsu

Vicky Harp*

Bass Clarinet

Vicky Harp*

Bassoon

Joshua Schnipke

Shannon Nelson

Contrabassoon

Eric Shankland

Horn

Andrew Schuck

Linda Brooking

Chris Haymond

Jon Dyer

Yuqing Wei

Mark Hendrickson

Trumpet

Sven Boemer

Ethan Wong

Vyas Alwar

Trombone

Cole Brooking

Johnny Leek

Zach Neely

Conall Anderson

Tuba

Adithya Subbiah

Timpani

Nicholas Vadasz

Percussion

Matthew Kangas

Soo Stahl

Aaryaa Tiwari

Chase Lee

Spencer Nisonoff

Keyboard

Jada Campbell

Harp

Tamara Dobranic

Conductor

Peter Yang

Italics denote principals
Asterisks (*) denote
instrument doubling

Theater Cast and Crew

Midsummer Night's Dream

ACT II, SCENE I

ACT V, SCENE I

Henry V

ACT III, SCENE I

Romeo and Juliet

ACT III, SCENE V

ACT V, SCENE III

ROBIN (PUCK) - Varika Pinnam

FAIRY / KING HENRY V- Catherine Pidgeon

OBERON / PARIS - Jason Davis

ROMEO - Rizo Rakhmanov

JULIET - Lauren Go

STAGE MANAGER /

INTIMACY COORDINATOR: Monica Taylor

CREW: Ben Homer & Emelyn Berg

MARKETING - Ananya Bhat

A Midsummer Night's Dream — In an enchanted forest, the fairy king Oberon and his queen are locked in a quarrel, and Oberon's servant Puck is happy to stir up mischief among them. Tonight's scenes catch the fairy world at its most playful: Puck boasting of the pranks he plays on unsuspecting mortals, and Oberon plotting an enchantment of his own with a magic flower.

Henry V — England's king faces a siege that could break his exhausted army. Rather than retreat, he calls his weary, wounded soldiers back to the fight one last time.

Romeo and Juliet — Two lovers from feuding families, secretly married. In the first scene, they part after their only night together. What follows drives the tragedy: to avoid a forced marriage to the nobleman Paris, Juliet and a trusted friar hatch a desperate plan. She drinks a potion that makes her appear dead, so she can slip away and reunite with Romeo. Word of the scheme is meant to reach him, but it never does. Prokofiev's music carries us through that unraveling, and when we return, Romeo has come to Juliet's tomb believing she is truly gone.

Technically Thespians Technically Thespians is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit theater troupe of tech professionals who found that the best way to scratch a creative itch after a day of problem-solving was to make theatre together. We're built on collaboration, creativity, and the belief that telling stories makes us better humans — at work and beyond. We strive to provide a space for artistic expression and to support the greater arts community through partnership, volunteerism, and charitable giving.

Technically Thespians will be performing our original production, *That Was Shakespeare*, at the Minnesota Fringe Festival from August 8-16. We are also preparing for our October 2026 GIVE show, *Love & Misdirection*. For more info & to purchase tickets, check out our website at <https://www.technicallythespians.com/2026-season>.



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Our Mascot

Moomie's musical journey began on the farms of Carnation, WA, when she started learning cowbell at just three months old. Her musical talents brought her to the Redmond Tech Orchestra where she happily spends her days enjoying soft classical music, munching on organic grass and grains, and being loved by the members of the orchestra.



In her spare time, Moomie loves to explore the Puget Sound and to find new friends to share her love of music. Her all-time favorite composers are Brahms and Ravel, and she loves Saint-Saëns' *Carnival of the Animals*, which has so many references to her animal friends! Moomie's excited to meet you all and see you at our future concerts.

Fun fact: Moomie weighs 10.2 pounds!

Upcoming Concerts

Join us this November 1st, 4:00pm at the Meydenbauer Convention Center as we explore the musical lineage that connects past and present. From Joe Hisaishi's *Spirited Away Suite* and John Williams' *Star Wars* theme to the foundational works of Holst and Korngold, the program traces how earlier composers shaped the modern orchestral voice. The evening will also feature a special appearance by our concerto competition winner.

Support the Orchestra

As a nonprofit organization, the Redmond Tech Orchestra relies on your generous donations to continue bringing music to the community. Your support helps us organize events and foster a love for music in the greater Redmond area. Please consider donating to help us keep the music alive. Every contribution, no matter the size, makes a significant impact.



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